CITY OF
Federal Way
Centered on Opportunity

RE-OPENING PLAN

A five-stage strategy for reopening city facilities, services, and programs

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Background

Covid-19 is a respiratory disease that is highly contagious and can be lethal to vulnerable group(s). Person-to-person spread appears to occur similar to other respiratory viruses, mainly via respiratory droplets produced when an infected person speaks, coughs, or sneezes. These droplets can land in the mouths, noses or eyes of people who are nearby or possibly be inhaled into the lungs. Although not likely to be the predominant mode of transmission, it is not clear the extent to which touching a surface contaminated with the virus and then touching the mouth, nose, or eyes contributes to transmission. Experts hypothesize that the disease has a 2 to 14 day incubation period and can be asymptomatic in many that are infected, who in turn can spread the disease.

COVID-19 can spread rapidly in settings of concentrated people, like office buildings, particularly when physical distancing is not possible. As we transition to re-opening City Hall to an in-person work environment significant precaution must be taken to keep everyone safe from exposure to COVID-19 and to prevent future outbreaks.

Purpose

This plan is being implemented to prevent the spread of COVID-19 to employees and the public and to address the reopening of City Hall anticipated for June 30, 2021.

On May 13, 2021, Governor Jay Inslee announced a statewide reopening date of June 30, 2021. Shortly thereafter, Mayor Jim Ferrell announced that City hall would open for in-person, full-capacity operation on June 30, consistent with state guidelines. The reopening plan is aimed at accomplishing this while mitigating the risks presented by COVID-19.

This plan intends to outline safety measures already implemented as well as provide specific and clear direction for all City employees and the public in accordance with WA State guidance.

Returning to Work

On May 14, 2021 Mayor Ferrell sent out a City wide email informing staff that Governor Inslee announced his plan to re-open Washington State no later than June 30th. The expectation is this will remove occupancy restrictions for businesses and government and everyone will be able to operate at 100% occupancy. When the State is open, City Hall will open matching the Governor's guidance. Working for a city is uniquely rewarding because our operations, projects, and programs directly impact the residents, workers, and visitors of the city. Providing the best level of service for our customers requires that we are present in the community. City staff needs to understand the people we are impacting, from knowing residents and business owners to knowing traffic patterns, the school locations, and popular parks and retail facilities. This can only be done effectively by being present. Simply commuting to work, grabbing a meal, or seeing new developments get constructed, staff gets to know the community. This adds perspective and understanding to our projects and programs.

This document is based on current guidance and is considered a working document. It will be updated as needed as additional guidance evolves.

Each department director is responsible for determining the need for Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) for each position and ensuring staff have been instructed and use appropriate PPE. In addition, the City will provide face masks, hand sanitizer and cleaning supplies.

Wellness Self-Check

First and most important, if you are sick please stay home and contact your supervisor!

Temperature Screening

Minimizing the risk of infected employees or the public that enter a City facility is a key safety strategy to protect against virus transmission. One objective criterion for screening for the virus is the presence of a fever. Therefore, employees will participate in temperature screenings whenever entering a City facility. A temperature checking kiosk will be located at all entries of City facilities. If your temperature is measured at **100.4 degrees or greater** employees must immediately exit the facility and call their supervisor.

The Screening Kiosk is one of the fastest and most accurate systems available. It provides a safer environment for all of us, employees and visitors, as we re-open the doors to City facilities.

Stand a few feet in front of the screen, the screen will indicate the temperature as well as green for pass or red if above the threshold. Your temperature is not stored or shared with any other member of the City. Therefore, it is not only important but is your responsibility to immediately leave the building and contact your supervisor if your temperature is measured at **100.4 degrees or greater** in order to protect others in the building. The supervisor will immediately contact HR and Facilities Maintenance.

Because exercise can affect body temperature, cool down after a strenuous workout for 5-10 minutes prior to checking your temperature.

Health Screening Assessment

Prior to entering the work area, employees are to self-assess if they are experiencing **ANY** of the following symptoms that cannot be contributed to a pre-existing known health condition:

- Dry Cough
- Shortness of breath or difficulty breathing
- Chills
- Repeated Shaking with Chills
- Sore Throat
- Headache
- Muscle Pain
- New Loss of Taste or Smell
- Nausea, diarrhea or vomiting

If so, immediately exit the facility and contact your supervisor.

Screened Out of the Workplace

An employee who has affirmed they have a temperature or qualifying symptom(s) as identified in the screening process, will stay at home until the symptoms resolve and will be charged sick, or other applicable leave.

Returning to Work following Illness

If an employee experiences any of the above-noted symptoms and reasonably believes they may have been exposed to COVID, after they have FULLY recovered from the illness with or without medical intervention, the employee may return to work ONLY after the following conditions have been met:

- With a negative test – 7 days after all symptoms resolved.
- Without testing – 10 days after all symptoms resolved.
- With a positive test – 14 days past illness onset **AND** fever resolved for 72+ hours without using fever reducing medication **AND** all symptoms resolved.

Consult with HR about other state and federal leave options that may be available.

Employee that Develops Symptoms

If an employee develops symptoms as noted above during the work day, the supervisor will immediately send the employee home or isolate them until they can go home. If an employee reasonably believes they may have been exposed to COVID they are to follow the protocol above. The supervisor will immediately contact HR and Facilities Maintenance.

When to Seek Emergency Medical Attention

Look for emergency warning signs for COVID-19. Seek emergency medical care immediately if you or someone you know is experiencing the following:

- Trouble breathing
- Persistent pain or pressure in the chest
- New confusion
- Inability to wake or stay awake
- Bluish lips or face

Call 911 or call ahead to your local emergency facility. Notify the operator that you are seeking care for yourself or someone who has or may have COVID-19.

See additional information under Isolation Precautions & Potential Exposure.

High-Risk Employees

High-risk employees, as defined by the CDC, will be accommodated upon request as required by law. Accommodations may include any of the following options: alternative work arrangements such as telecommuting, assignment to an alternative or remote work location, reassignment, and/or social distancing measures. A doctor recommendation may be requested to facilitate needed accommodations.

According to the CDC (based upon available information to date) those at high risk for severe illness from COVID-19 include:

- People aged 65 years and older.
- People who live in a nursing home or long-term care facility.
- People who have heart disease with complications.
- People who are immunocompromised including cancer treatment.
- People of any age and severe obesity (body mass index ([BM]I)≥40) or certain underlying medical conditions, particularly if not well controlled, such as those with diabetes, renal failure or liver disease might also be at risk.
- People who are pregnant should be monitored since they are known to be at risk to severe viral illnesses; however, to date data on COVID-19 has not shown increased risk.

Many conditions can cause a person to be immunocompromised, including cancer treatment, bone marrow or organ transplantation, immune deficiencies, poorly controlled HIV or AIDS, prolonged use of corticosteroids and other immune weakening medications, or when recovering from a major medical procedure. **It is best to follow the advice of your healthcare provider if you feel that you are in a high risk category for severe illness from COVID-19.**

All requests for accommodation will be evaluated and a determination will be made if the City can reasonably accommodate. If accommodation is not possible, the City will comply with Governor Inslee's Proclamation 20-46.3 regarding high-risk employees, which is currently in effect through the current state of emergency initially proclaimed in Proclamation 20-05, or until otherwise rescinded or amended. HR will provide explanations of leave options to an impacted employee.

Expectations at City Facilities

The following best practices are expected to be followed when in a City facility:

- **Face Masks**
  Unvaccinated Staff: Consistent with the Governor's order, it is the policy of the City that a face mask is required in any common area or at any time that you are within 6 feet of another person and during all face-to-face contact with the public including when separated by a barrier. Face masks are not required when working alone in an enclosed office, vehicle, or job site, or otherwise working along. Face masks are not required to be worn by those who are deaf or hard of hearing and rely on language cues such as

facial markers and expression and mouth movements as a part of communication, nor for those with whom they are communicating.

If you need additional face masks contact your supervisor or HR. This policy will be in effect until directed by the City after the Governor's Order is lifted and violation of this policy will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

<u>Working alone</u>: Clarification from the Department of Health
Someone is considered to be working alone when they are isolated from interaction with other people and have little or no expectation of in-person interruption. How often a worker is able to work alone throughout the day may vary. Examples include:

- *A lone worker inside heavy equipment or vehicle.*
- *A person by themselves inside an office with four walls and a door.*
- *A lone worker inside of a cubicle with 4 walls (one with an opening for an entryway) which are high enough to block the breathing zone of anyone walking by, and whose work activity will not require anyone to come inside of the cubicle and/or the worker can maintain social distancing.*
- *A worker by themselves outside with no anticipated contact with others.*

Vaccinated Staff: For those employees who are fully vaccinated, and are comfortable doing so, are authorized to work without a mask, indoors and outdoors. L&I requires that employers maintain records of those who are fully vaccinated if the employee will not be wearing a face mask[1]. In order to comply with L&I guidelines the following applies to those who are fully vaccinated and wish to not wear a face mask:

Employees (full-time, part-time, seasonal, temporary, interns, and volunteers) will be required to provide one of the following to Human Resources:

- Show CDC vaccination card to a member of HR.
- Show CDC vaccination card stored on your phone or electronic device to a member of HR.
- Provide a photocopy of your vaccination card as a separate document to HR.
- Provide documentation from a healthcare provider of state immunization information system record.
- Sign a form that attests your status of being **fully*** vaccinated available in HR or on the intranet under Documents and Forms, Human Resources, Forms, Medical, Attestation Form

[1]Employees in recreation programs should follow mask wearing guidance specific to them to be provided by their manager.

**Fully vaccinated is defined as 14 days or more beyond your second Moderna or Pfizer vaccine or 14 days after the one-shot Johnson & Johnson vaccine.*

Once you have fulfilled one of the above requirements, your department director will be notified who will notify your immediate supervisor that you are no longer required to wear a mask.

Public: Signs will be posted requiring all non-vaccinated members of the public to wear a mask. Neither the City nor staff has the authority to verify a member of the public's vaccination status. City staff will not investigate or question the public as to why they are not wearing a face mask.

<u>Accommodation</u>: If an employee is unable to wear a face mask due to a physical disability that prevents easily wearing or removing a face covering, or has been advised by a medical professional that wearing a face covering may pose a risk due to a medical reason, please request accommodation through HR. All requests for accommodation will be evaluated and a determination will be made if the City can reasonably accommodate the request.

- **Safe Interactions with Others**
  Employees should strive to minimize face-to-face contact with both other employees and the public by using the telephone, online conferencing, or emailing to conduct business as much as possible, even when in the same building. Employees should try to minimize citizens waiting in the common areas of City Hall by setting appointments for services where practicable.

- **Practice Good Hygiene, including:**
  - ✓ Wash hands frequently and effectively with soap and water or an alcohol-based sanitizer.
  - ✓ Use tissue to cover your mouth and nose when coughing or sneezing, then throwing the tissue in a wastebasket. If tissue is not available, cough or sneeze into the upper sleeve, not the hands.
  - ✓ Avoid touching your eyes, nose and mouth.

- ✓ Avoid using co-workers phones, desks, offices, supplies or other related work tools and equipment.
- ✓ Follow social distancing requirements (at least six feet apart) in hallways, stairwells, elevators, and common work areas.

City Facilities

The City of Federal Way will follow Governor Inslee's Safe Start Washington Phased Reopening Plan and OSHA's recommended guidance for employees returning to work after the COVID-19 "Stay Home" order is lifted.

Safety measures include:

- Soap and running water will be abundantly provided at all facilities for frequent handwashing.
- Hand sanitizer will be placed at strategic locations around City Hall.
- Trash receptacles will be at strategic locations around City facilities.
- Continued use of high efficiency air filters and a robust ventilation system in City buildings.
- Physical barriers have been installed in high contact areas. Contact your supervisor if you feel there is a need for additional barriers. Your supervisor will work with Facilities Maintenance to evaluate the request and make a determination regarding additional barriers.
- Physical distancing, maintaining six-feet of distance, will continue to the extent possible in City facilities.
- If an employee or member of the public reports feeling sick at a City facility, notify your supervisor, who will notify HR. When necessary, the area where that person worked/visited will be closed and disinfected by Facilities Maintenance staff. Alternate work location may be necessary for employees in the affected area until it can be properly sanitized.

Disinfecting

Disinfectants are available to employees at all City facilities. Cleaning supplies will be frequently replenished. Submit a Parks Work Order via intranet to request additional supplies. Soap and running water and hand sanitizer are abundantly available at all locations for frequent handwashing.

- Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) can be found at G:/Covid-19/SDSThe City will continue to use its regular custodial services and ensure services are in line with CDC daily cleaning and disinfecting guidelines.

- Disinfectant sprays and wipes are provided to departments, conditioned on market availability. Employees should routinely clean frequently touched surfaces, including workstations, keyboards, countertops and doorknobs.
- All employees should assist with cleaning in common areas as they are able.
- Customer-facing employees should clean the customer touchpoints after customer interactions as they are able.

Elevators

- Only one person may ride in an elevator at a time unless riders are of the same household. Elevator use should be reserved for individuals with mobility concerns and physical distancing should be maintained.

Meeting Rooms

- Maximum capacity limits, consistent with state and federal guidance have been posted on all meeting rooms. Staff is expected to adhere to these limits.
- Attendees should be encouraged, whenever possible, to attend meetings virtually.
- Meeting rooms are cleaned once per day as indicated by CDC guidelines by Facility Maintenance staff. As additional precautionary measures, it is strongly encouraged that the city staff person hosting the meeting wipe down the table with bleach wipes before and after the meeting.

- Council Chambers will be cleaned once per day as indicated by CDC guidelines.

Work Rooms and lunchroom

- Maintain social distancing, in work rooms and lunch rooms.
- Avoid touching frequently touched surfaces with your fingers or hands.
- Clean counters and control surfaces on kitchen appliances before and after use.
- Lunchroom seating should maintain social distancing.

Restrooms

- Restrooms will be cleaned once per day per CDC guidelines.
- Occupancy limit of restrooms is two people. If upon entry you find two people occupying the restroom, please wait outside until someone leaves.
- When exiting the restroom use a paper towel to open the door. The paper towel should be thrown away in the garbage can by the door or upon return to your work area.

Fleet Vehicles

- When driving City vehicles, maintain one occupant per vehicle if possible.
- For Maintenance Staff in City vehicles, maintain a maximum of two occupants per vehicle. Unvaccinated employees are required to wear masks.
- Disinfecting supplies has been provided in all fleet vehicles. Employees are expected to clean before and after use.

Physical Barriers

- Barriers have been installed at front counters to protect the public and employees that must conduct in-person business and physical distancing is not possible.
- Markers have been placed on the floor on the public side of the barriers to mark social distances of six-feet.
- Signs have been placed throughout all City facilities reminding employees and members of the public about COVID-19, physical distancing, hygiene, and proper mask usage.

Public Access

What visitors should know when visiting City Hall or other City facilities:

In an effort to maintain physical distancing and the safety of everyone in City facilities, there will be some noticeable changes that visitors should be aware. Public access to City Hall and other City facilities will resume when local government is permitted to fully reopen to the public, currently anticipated to be June 30.

- City employees who have not provided proof of being fully vaccinated are required to wear face masks. **Visitors to a City facility are required to wear a face mask** if not fully vaccinated. Signs will be posted throughout the facilities with information about masks requirements for unvaccinated individuals.
- Entrance to City facilities will continue to be via the main entrance.
- Visitors are encouraged to voluntarily comply with temperature screenings when entering a City facility. A temperature checking kiosk is located at all entries of City facilities.
- If you know you have recently had a temperature, please wait at least 72 hours before visiting.
- All individuals feeling sick or having any symptoms of COVID-19 should remain home.
- Signs are posted in City facilities with the signs and symptoms of COVID-19. Prior to entering a City facility, visitors are asked to self-assess if they are experiencing **ANY** of the posted symptoms and if so, please go home.
- Visitors should minimize their time in City Hall and complete their business as quickly as possible.
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Visitors are strongly encourage to check the City website for the latest information and schedule an appointment if able; business should also be completed online whenever possible.
Everyone will be encouraged to physically distance at all times.

The following measures are also being taken to reduce exposures in City facilities:

- City facilities will be cleaned daily.
- Hand sanitizer is placed at strategic locations around City facilities.
- Trash receptacles will be at strategic locations around City facilities.
- All visitors should abide at all times by State and Department of Health recommendations currently in place.

- Only one person may ride in an elevator at a time unless riders are of the same household. Persons with mobility concerns should be given priority for elevator use.

Public Meetings

- The City will resume in-person Council meetings in Chambers on the first and third Tuesday of the month beginning July 20, 2021.
- Chambers will be set up to follow safety protocols as outlined by the State including space to achieve social distancing, and maintaining online participation.
- Signs will be posted to clearly outline safety protocols in Chambers.
- Directors will be expected to physically attend if they have an item on the agenda. If not, remote attendance is acceptable. The City Clerk, City Attorney, and IT staff member are required to attend in person.
- Employees will be expected to physically attend if they have an item on the agenda.
- Committee meetings will resume in-person beginning in July following the same safety protocols as Council meetings.
- Commission meetings will continue to be held remotely until the emergency OPMA rules are lifted.

Isolation Precautions & Potential Exposure

Employees must follow all normal departmental notification procedures if they will be absent.

If an employee believes they are exposed to COVID-19, the employee must notify their supervisor, who must then notify their department director and Human Resources if any of the below situations occur. Some of these are also FMLA qualifying events requiring HR to work directly with the employee:

- **If an employee has symptoms of COVID-19 including fever, cough, or shortness of breath and the employee has had close and prolonged contact with a sick person or with a person confirmed to have COVID-19,** that employee should begin home isolation immediately.
- **If an employee has no symptoms but has had close and prolonged contact with a sick person or a person confirmed to have COVID-19**, that employee should begin home self-quarantine immediately **unless fully vaccinated**.
- **If an employee is sick with fever or respiratory (cold or flu-like) symptoms but has had no known exposures to a person with COVID-19,** that employee should stay home and away from others until 72 hours after the fever is gone and symptoms get better.

If any of the above occurs and the employee has FULLY recovered from the illness with or without medical intervention, the employee may return to work ONLY after the following conditions have been met:

- With a negative test – 7 days after all symptoms resolved.
- Without testing – 10 days after all symptoms resolved.
- With a positive test – 14 days past illness onset **AND** fever resolved for 72+ hours without using fever reducing medication **AND** all symptoms resolved.
- **If an employee has had secondary close and prolonged contact with a person who has had first close and prolonged contact with a confirmed COVID-19 case and neither the employee nor the person they had contact with are showing symptoms**, that employee should continue to work as regularly assigned. Should the employee choose to stay home, sick leave may be able to be used.

  Note: Prolonged exposure/contact means that you are within six-feet or less of someone confirmed with COVID-19 for 15 minutes or longer.

If an employee believes they have had prolonged contact and/or exposure to someone with COVID-19, they need to: 1) first notify their supervisor (who must then notify Human Resources), 2) get tested and 3) contact their health care provider immediately for further direction.

It is critical that employee confidentiality be maintained for potential exposures (including not identifying the name of the individual exposed to other staff). Due to the sensitivity of this medical information, HR can provide further guidance on maintaining privacy in communications.

Federal Way's Response to a Positive Case of COVID-19

In an employee tests positive for COVID-19, and is in the workplace, that individual will immediately be sent home and asked to isolate until recovered *(more details below)*. If the employee is at home and has tested positive, they will not return to work until they are recovered from COVID-19.

In the workplace, all work areas, vehicles and equipment that the employee may have come into contact with will be closed or remain unused until thoroughly disinfected.

The confirmed employee should follow the quarantine protocol, employee may use all leave types available.

Notification will also be sent out to all employees within the workgroup that would most likely have the highest probability of direct exposure. Notified employees will follow the Isolation Precautions and Potential Exposure guidelines above.

The vehicle number of a potentially exposed/contaminated City vehicle will be provided to the Fleet Coordinator. **No personal identifying information will be provided about the employee and privacy will be maintained.**

It is critical that employee confidentiality be maintained for confirmed cases (including not identifying the name of the individual exposed to other staff). Due to the sensitivity of this medical information, HR can provide further guidance on maintaining privacy in communications.

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